CAREER ROADMAP | BLUE TEAM

SOC ANALYST MASTERY

Zero to Advance

Complete roadmap for SOC Tier 1, Tier 2 and Tier 3

Foundation | Tier 1 | Tier 2 | Tier 3

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1 What is a SOC?

SOC = Security Operations Center. It is the 24/7 heart of cybersecurity, where analysts watch, detect and respond to threats around the clock.

TIER 1	**Alert Triage** Monitors SIEM alerts and filters out false positives.
TIER 2	**Incident Responder** Deep investigation and containment of threats.
TIER 3	**Threat Hunter** Proactively hunts for hidden attackers and performs forensics.

01

DAY 0 - 30 | ZERO

Foundation

You cannot defend what you don't understand.

Networking

- TCP/IP, OSI Model, Ports
- DNS, DHCP, HTTP/HTTPS
- VPN, Firewall

Operating Systems

- Linux commands **[must]**
- Windows Event Logs
- Active Directory

Cybersecurity Core

- CIA Triad, Cyber Kill Chain
- MITRE ATT&CK Framework
- OWASP Top 10

Practice

- Install VirtualBox + Kali Linux + a Windows VM

02

DAY 30 - 60 | TIER 1

Core SOC Skills

This is your main job role.

SIEM Mastery

- What is a SIEM?
- Learn **Splunk** (most important), Microsoft Sentinel, IBM QRadar

Log Analysis

- Firewall and antivirus logs
- Windows Event ID 4624 / 4625
- Sysmon

Alert triage process

Alert Arrives > **Check Severity** > **True / False Positive?** > **Create Ticket** > **Escalate**

Ticketing Tools

- JIRA, ServiceNow, TheHive

Phishing Analysis

- Analyze email headers
- Check URLs on VirusTotal and Any.Run

DAY 60 - 90 | TIER 2

03 Advanced Analysis

From triage to real incident response.

Incident response lifecycle (NIST model)

Preparation > Detection > Containment > Eradication > Recovery > Lessons Learned

EDR and SOAR

- CrowdStrike, SentinelOne, Cortex XDR
- Learn how SOAR automates response

Threat Intelligence

- IOCs: IP, hash, domain
- Feeds like AlienVault OTX and MISP

Network Forensics

- Wireshark and reading PCAP files
- Detect C2 communication

MITRE ATT&CK in Action

- Map an attack to techniques like T1078 and T1003

04

DAY 90 - 120 | TIER 3

Threat Hunting and DFIR

Hunt the attackers nobody has found yet.

Threat Hunting

- Proactive, hypothesis-based hunting
- Splunk queries (SPL) and KQL

Digital Forensics

- Memory forensics with Volatility
- Disk forensics with Autopsy

Malware Analysis Basics

- Static vs dynamic analysis in a sandbox

Threat Modeling and Reporting

- How to write a perfect incident report

6 Master Tool Kit

Category	Tools you must learn
SIEM	Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel (KQL), Elastic Security
Network	Wireshark, Zeek, Suricata
Endpoint	CrowdStrike, Microsoft Defender
Intel	VirusTotal, Abuse.ch, Shodan
Lab	TryHackMe (SOC Level 1 Path), LetsDefend.io (best for SOC), CyberDefenders (Blue Team Labs)

7 Live Labs for Practice

Theory is 20%, practical is 80%.

1. **LetsDefend.io**
   Real SOC alert simulation. Do 1 alert daily.
2. **TryHackMe**
   Complete the "SOC Level 1" and "Pre-Security" paths.
3. **Splunk BOTS Dataset**
   Boss of the SOC: practice real log investigation.

8 Certifications Roadmap

BEGINNER	Google Cybersecurity Certificate > CompTIA Security+
FOR A SOC JOB	CompTIA CySA+ | Microsoft SC-200 | Splunk Core Certified User
ADVANCED	Certified SOC Analyst (CSA, EC-Council) | Blue Team Level 1 (BTL1)

9 Interview + Resume Tip

Add this to your resume:

> *"Monitored SIEM alerts, performed triage on phishing/malware alerts, used MITRE ATT&CK for investigation, worked on Wireshark & Splunk."*